

PV Internship

Task 4

Severity & Case Classification

Classify adverse drug reactions based on seriousness and expectedness. Evaluate multiple cases and determine their clinical impact using pharmacovigilance guidelines.

CASE STUDY 1

6 yr old male child (named EA) with body weight 17 kg, admitted with history of fever, swollen neck, abdominal pain joint pain and reddened tongue and diagnosed as Kawasaki disease. His lab investigation data: Hb: 10.0 gm% ,TC: 10900/c.mm Platelets: 2.87 lakhs/c.mm, PCV: 33.5% MCV: 78.8 fL.Treatment was started on 23rd June 2023 with Inj.Intravenous Immunoglobulin (IVIG) (Mfg by: Reliance life sciences, batch no: ID05G21020, Mfg date: Sep 2022, Expiry date: Aug 2025) Dose - 2g/kg/day IV OD. The patient developed itching all over the body and rashes on 23rd June 2023 following the injection. Drug was withdrawn on 24th June 2023 and the reaction was managed with Inj .Chlopheniramine IV and Inj.Dexamethasone IV . He recovered from the reaction on 24th June 2023. The suspected drug was again given to the patient on 27th June 2023 and itching all over the body recurred the same day. The drug was stopped and appropriate treatment given.

Parameter	Classification
ADR	Generalised itching and rash
Severity	Not reported
Seriousness	Non-serious
Expectedness	Expected
Clinical impact	Limited and reversible

It is classified as **non-serious** because the case did not report death, a life-threatening condition, significant disability, congenital anomaly, or another reported serious criterion.

The reaction was classified as **expected** because skin reactions including **rash and pruritus** are recognised with IVIG products.

CASE STUDY 2

Source: Metformin-Associated Lactic Acidosis: A Case Report

<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5807253/>

Parameter	Classification
ADR	Lactic acidosis
Severity	Severe
Seriousness	Serious
Expectedness	Expected
Clinical impact	Severe and clinically significant

The reaction was classified as **serious** because the patient developed a severe clinical condition requiring intensive management and renal replacement therapy.

The reaction was **expected** because lactic acidosis is a recognised serious adverse reaction associated with metformin and is specifically addressed in its prescribing information.

The clinical impact was significant because the patient experienced severe metabolic disturbance accompanied by confusion and hypotension and required advanced medical management.

CASE STUDY 3

Methylphenidate-associated reversible cerebral vasoconstriction syndrome

A 44-year-old woman receiving methylphenidate developed a **sudden severe thunderclap headache during exercise**. Medical evaluation and imaging supported a diagnosis of **reversible cerebral vasoconstriction syndrome (RCVS)**. Methylphenidate was discontinued and the patient received treatment. Follow-up demonstrated a favourable outcome.

Parameter	Classification
ADR	Reversible cerebral vasoconstriction syndrome (RCVS)
Severity	Severe
Seriousness	Serious
Expectedness	Unexpected
Clinical impact	Clinically significant neurological event

The reaction was classified as **serious** because it represented a significant neurological condition requiring hospital evaluation and medical management.

The reaction was classified as **unexpected** because the published case describes RCVS as an unexpected adverse drug reaction to methylphenidate and states that it was not part of the established safety profile.

The sudden severe headache and need for medical evaluation and treatment suggest a significant clinical impact.